

Michael David Sacks

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Employment

Clarkson University

Assistant Professor of Economics and Financial Studies	2020-2026
Associate Professor of Economics and Financial Studies	2026-present

University of Louisville

Visiting Assistant Professor	2018-2020
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West Virginia University

Visiting Assistant Professor	2016-2018
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Education

University of California, Irvine

<i>Ph.D. Economics</i>	Irvine, CA
	2011 – 2016

University of California, Irvine

<i>M.A. Social Sciences: Mathematical Behavioral Sciences</i>	Irvine, CA
	2011 – 2014

Towson University

<i>B.S. Economics, summa cum laude & departmental honors</i>	Towson, MD
	2006 – 2010

Fields of Expertise

- Political Economy; Public Economics; Game Theory; Industrial Organization.

Publications

1. (2026) Dynamic Price Competition and Evolutionary Behavior with Search (with Blake Allison). *International Journal of Industrial Organization*, 109, Article No. 103337. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.ijindorg.2026.103337>
2. (2026) Minimum Resale Price Maintenance can Reduce Prices (with Jacob Burgdorf). *Economics Letters*, 264, Article No. 112944. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.econlet.2026.112944>
3. (2026) Reimbursing Consumers' Switching Costs in Network and Non-network Industries (with Jiawei Chen). *Journal of Economics & Management Strategy*, 35(1), pp. 99–125. <https://doi.org/10.1111/jems.12635>.
4. (2024) Radicalization (with Jean-Paul Carvalho). *The Economic Journal*, 134, pp. 1019–1068. <https://doi.org/10.1093/ej/uead094>.
5. (2024) Failed Secular Revolutions: Religious Belief, Competition, and Extremism (with Jean-Paul Carvalho and Jared Rubin). *Public Choice*, 200, pp. 561–586. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s11127-023-01112-6>.
6. (2021) Incentives for the Over-Provision of Public Goods. *Journal of Economic Behavior and Organization*, 191, pp. 197–213. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jebo.2021.08.033>.

7. (2021) The Economics of Religious Communities (with Jean-Paul Carvalho). *Journal of Public Economics*, 201, Article No. 104481. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jpubeco.2021.104481>.
8. (2018) Going Along or Going Independent? A Dynamic Analysis of Nonprofit Alliances (with Jiawei Chen). *B.E. Journal of Economic Analysis and Policy*, 18(2). <https://doi.org/10.1515/bejeap-2017-0009>.
9. (2017) Education, Identity, and Community: Lessons from Jewish Emancipation (with Jean-Paul Carvalho and Mark Koyama). *Public Choice*, 171(1), pp. 119–143. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s11127-016-0400-1>.
10. (2015) Competition Between Open Source and Proprietary Software: Strategies for Survival. *Journal of Management Information Systems*, 32(3), pp. 268–295. <https://doi.org/10.1080/07421222.2015.1099391>.

Ongoing Research

1. Contact Traps.
2. Composition Effects in Platforms with Population Heterogeneity.
3. Incubation and the Emergence of Identity-Based Organizations.
4. Advertising, Political Preferences, and Partial Foreclosure in Multisided Platforms.

Teaching

- Clarkson University: Principles of Macroeconomics, Intermediate Microeconomics*, Economics of Innovation*, Industrial and Supply Chain Economics*, Independent Study in Microeconomics*, Industrial Organization and the Supply Chain (online MBA), Applied Economics (residential MBA).
- University of Louisville: Principles of Macroeconomics, Honors Seminar: Global Economic Issues, Economics of Entrepreneurship, Economics of Antitrust, Game Theory*.
- West Virginia University: Principles of Microeconomics, Principles of Macroeconomics, Intermediate Microeconomics*, Mathematical Economics*.
- UC Irvine: Intermediate Economics II*, Probability and Statistics for Economics II, Game Theory I*.

* Denotes calculus-based courses.

Professional & University Service

- Referee - *B.E. Journal of Economic Analysis and Policy*; *Canadian Journal of Economics*; *Contemporary Economic Policy*; *Eastern Economic Journal*, *Economics of Governance*; *Games*; *Industry and Innovation*; *Journal of Comparative Economics*; *Journal of Economic Behavior and Organization*; *Journal of Economic Dynamics and Control*; *Journal of Economics, Theology and Religion*; *Journal of Institutional Economics*; *Journal of Management Information Systems*; *Journal of Public Economic Theory*; *Journal of Public Economics*; *Journal for the Scientific Study of Religion*; *Mathematical Social Sciences*; *Public Choice*; *Quarterly Journal of Economics*; *Scandinavian Journal of Economics*; *Scientific Reports*; *Social Choice and Welfare*; *Social Science Journal*; *Sustainability: Theory and Society*,

- Search Committee Chair, Assistant Professor of Economics,
- Search Committee Member, Visiting Assistant Professor in Economics,
- Search Committee Member, Assistant Professor in Healthcare Management,
- Search Committee Member, Open Rank Position in Economics,
- Reh Center Advisory Council, Clarkson University (2025-present),
- Recruiting and Marketing Committee, Clarkson University (2024-present),
- Undergraduate Recruiting Committee, Clarkson University Reh School of Business (2022-present, Chair 2024-present),
- Undergraduate Policy Committee, Clarkson University Reh School of Business (2022-present, Chair 2024-2025),
- Learning Resources Committee, Clarkson University (2024-present),
- Operations Manual Revisions Committee, Clarkson University (2024),
- School of Business Reimagining Clarkson Taskforce (2023),
- Search Committee Chair, Visiting Assistant Professor in Economics (2022),
- Economics Coordinator, Mathematical Economics Major, Clarkson University (2021-2025),
- Search Committee Member, Assistant Professor in Organizational Studies
- Faculty Advisor, Omicron Delta Epsilon International Economics Honors Society (2021-present),
- Graduate Studies Committee - West Virginia University Economics Department (2017-2018),
- Graduate student liaison - UC Irvine Economics Department,
- Mentor for incoming graduate students - UC Irvine Economics Department,
- Coordinator - Institute for Mathematical Behavioral Sciences (IMBS) Friday Seminar Series (2014-2016); Twelfth, Thirteenth, and Fourteenth Annual IMBS Graduate Student Conference (2014-2016).

Presentations

- **2026** ASREC Conference, George Mason University.
- **2025** ASREC Conference.
- **2024** Oklahoma State University.
- **2023** ASREC Conference, Society for the Advancement of Economic Theory Annual Conference.
- **2022** ASREC Europe Conference.
- **2020** Louisiana State University, Clarkson University.
- **2019** U.S. Federal Trade Commission, U.S. Department of Justice.

- **2018** University of Central Arkansas, 16th Annual International Industrial Organization Conference, Christopher Newport University.
- **2017** 2017 North American Summer Meeting of the Econometric Society, 15th Annual International Industrial Organization Conference.
- **2016** European Association for Research in Industrial Economics 43rd Annual Conference, Western Economic Association 91st Annual Conference, IMBS Seminar, UC Irvine.
- **2015** UC Irvine: Theory, History, and Development, IMBS and Institute for the Study of Religion, Economics, and Society (Chapman University) Workshop on the Economics of Religion and Culture, Towson University.
- **2014** UC Irvine: Theory, History, and Development, Twelfth Annual IMBS Graduate Student Conference, Tenth Annual California Graduate Student Conference: Center for the Study of Democracy, IMBS Seminar, UC Irvine (2x).
- **2013** IMBS Seminar, UC Irvine.

Awards

- David D. Reh School of Business Service Award, Clarkson University (2024-2025)
- MBA Professor of the Year, Clarkson University (2024-2025),
- Outstanding New Teacher Award, Clarkson University (2023),
- Summer Grant, NET Institute (2016),
- Jean-Claude Falmagne Dissertation Award, UC Irvine (2016),
- A. Kimball Romney Award for outstanding graduate paper: "Public and Club Goods When Private Costs Have Negative Externalities," UC Irvine (2016),
- Sheen T. Kassouf Fellowship for best graduate student, UC Irvine (2015-2016),
- Dissertation Completion Fellowship, UC Irvine (2016),
- Outstanding TA Award, UC Irvine (2014),
- IMBS Service Award (2014, 2015, 2016),
- Merit Fellowship in Economics, UC Irvine (Spring, 2015),
- UC Irvine Summer Research Fellowship (2014, 2015),
- Merit Fellowship in Economics, UC Irvine: (2011-2016),
- Social Science Tuition Fellowship, UC Irvine (2011),
- Provost's Scholarship Towson University (2006-2010),
- Departmental Honors, Economics, Towson University (2010).